PEW RESEARCH CENTER
SEPTEMBER 22-25, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,000

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. The debate in Washington over jobs and the deficit					
September 22-25, 2011	35	26	19	19	1
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
September 15-18, 2011: The debate in Washington over President Obama's jobs legislation	31	28	19	21	2
September 8-11, 2011: *Barack Obama's speech about jobs to a joint session of Congress*	28	18	17	36	1
July 28-31, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	41	27	15	17	*
July 21-24, 2011	38	28	17	17	*
July 14-17, 2011	34	29	18	19	*
June 16-19, 2011: *Debate in Washington over whether to raise the federal debt limit*	24	26	22	28	*
June 2-5, 2011	23	24	22	31	*
May 26-29, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	25	26	20	29	*
May 12-15, 2011	21	26	24	28	1
May 5-8, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	29	28	22	20	1
April 21-25, 2011	30	31	18	21	*
April 14-17, 2011	36	27	18	19	1
April 7-10, 2011: *The threat of a government shutdown because of budget disagreements in Washington*	47	26	15	12	*
March 31-April 3, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	30	27	21	22	*
March 17-20, 2011	24	25	24	26	1
March 3-6, 2011	26	29	19	26	1
February 17-20, 2011	27	30	17	25	1
December 2-5, 2010	35	25	21	17	2
December 2-5, 2010: *The debate in Washington over the federal income tax cuts passed when George W. Bush was president*	39	26	17	17	1
November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission*	15	21	21	41	1
September 16-19, 2010: *The debate in Washington over competing Democratic and Republican tax plans*	21	24	21	34	*
September 9-12, 2010	16	19	22	42	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 8-11, 2009: *The debate in Washington over the federal budget*	22	28	19	31	*
March 27-30, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's budget proposal*	28	34	18	19	1
March 6-9, 2009: *Obama proposing a $630 billion fund for overhauling health care*	41	32	13	14	*
February 27-March 2, 2009: *Barack Obama's budget proposal for next year that raises taxes on wealthy Americans and increases spending on health care, education and other programs*	47	34	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009: *The Obama administration's plan to help homeowners facing foreclosure which could cost as much as $275 billion dollars*	31	36	19	13	1
February 20-23, 2009: *The $780 billion economic stimulus legislation approved by Congress and signed into law by President Obama*	41	37	14	8	*
February 13-16, 2009: *Congress passing Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	50	32	13	5	*
February 6-9, 2009: *The debate in Congress over Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	41	33	15	11	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	36	29	22	13	*
January 16-19, 2009: *Debate in Washington over what the government should do about the nation's economic problems*	35	33	17	15	*
January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year*	35	30	19	16	*
December 19-22, 2008: *The Bush administration's plan to provide billions in emergency loans to U.S. automakers*	37	33	16	13	1
December 12-15, 2008: *The debate over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	40	33	18	9	*
December 5-8, 2008: *The debate in Congress over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	34	38	17	11	*
November 21-24, 2008	41	26	17	15	1
October 3-6, 2008: *The debate in Washington over a plan to use government funds to stabilize financial markets*	62	26	7	5	*
September 26-29, 2008	60	22	10	8	*
September 12-15, 2008: *The federal government taking control of the mortgage companies Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac*	28	35	19	17	1
March 20-24, 2008: *The buyout of Wall Street investment bank Bear Stearns*	21	26	21	32	*
February 8-11, 2008: *President Bush and Congress agreeing on an economic Stimulus plan*	22	33	23	21	1
January 25-28, 2008	24	36	19	21	*
February, 2003: *George W. Bush's tax cut and economic stimulus plan*	26	33	23	16	2
February, 2003	26	33	23	16	2
January, 2003	28	34	21	15	2

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February, 2002: *The debate in Congress over George W. Bush's budget and tax cut plan*	17	31	28	23	1
April, 2001	24	38	20	18	*
February, 2001: *George W. Bush's tax cut plan*	31	35	19	14	1
August, 1997: *The debate in Washington about the federal budget*	14	34	25	26	1
May, 1997	16	38	23	22	1
February, 1997	19	28	22	29	2
March, 1996	24	35	23	18	*
January, 1996	32	42	17	9	*
September, 1995	20	35	27	18	*
August, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the federal budget*	18	34	27	20	1
February, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the Balanced Budget Amendment*	12	31	28	28	1
August, 1993: The debate in Congress over Bill Clinton's budget bill	30	36	21	13	*
June, 1993	12	38	31	18	1
February, 1993: *Bill Clinton's economic plan*	49	36	10	5	*
September, 1992 *(RV)*: *George Bush's plan to improve the economy by cutting government spending and cutting taxes*	28	44	18	9	1
November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement*	34	33	20	11	2
October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit*	34	37	17	12	*
August, 1989: *Passage of a bill to bailout ailing savings and loan institutions*	26	30	20	23	1
b. Debate at the United Nations over the status of the Palestinian territories					
September 22-25, 2011	17	20	28	34	1
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
May 26-29, 2011: *Debate about how to resolve the Israeli-Palestinian dispute*	18	23	24	34	*
September 30-October 3, 2010: *Israeli-Palestinian peace talks*	11	26	29	24	1
September 16-19, 2010	13	21	26	40	*
September 2-6, 2010: *Israeli-Palestinian peace talks in Washington*	14	24	27	35	1
March 26-29, 2010: *Reports about tensions between Israel and the United States*	20	27	21	31	1
March 19-22, 2010: *Reports about tensions in the Middle East between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	28	27	30	1
June 19-22, 2009: *The situation between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	26	30	29	1
January 23-26, 2009: *Conflict between the Israeli military and Hamas forces in Gaza*	31	31	18	20	*
January 16-19, 2009	24	31	22	22	1
January 9-12, 2009	34	35	18	13	0
January 2-4, 2009	28	32	22	18	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
March 7-10, 2008: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	20	33	26	21	*
January 11-14, 2008: *News about President Bush attending peace talks in Israel*	16	30	23	30	1
Nov. 30-Dec. 3, 2007: *The Middle East Peace Summit in Annapolis, Maryland*	11	25	24	39	1
August, 2006: *The military conflict between Israel and Hezbollah forces in Lebanon*	40	34	14	10	2
September, 2003: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	31	36	20	13	*
June, 2003: *President Bush's summit meeting with world leaders and with the prime ministers of Israel and the Palestinian Authority*	20	36	24	19	1
Early June, 2003: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	26	40	20	13	1
December, 2002	29	36	22	12	1
Early October, 2002	32	39	20	8	1
June, 2002	38	33	18	10	1
April, 2002	38	37	14	10	1
Early April, 2002	44	33	13	9	1
December, 2001	31	40	19	9	1
Early September, 2001	21	33	25	20	1
April, 2001: *Continued violence in the Middle East*	22	34	24	19	1
January, 2001: *Renewed efforts at reaching a peace agreement in the Middle East*	21	32	29	17	1
Mid-October, 2000: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	30	38	18	13	1
Early October, 2000: *Renewed violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	21	30	27	21	1
July, 2000: *The Middle East peace summit at Camp David*	15	30	24	31	*
November, 1998: *The latest Mideast peace agreement between Israel and the Palestinians*	18	33	28	19	2
Early October, 1998 (RVs): *Renewed efforts at reaching a peace agreement in the Middle East*	21	40	27	12	*
January, 1997: *Renewed tensions between Israelis and Palestinians over Hebron*	12	23	29	35	1
October, 1996: *Renewed violence between Israelis & Palestinians on the West Bank and in Jerusalem*	17	34	26	23	*
September, 1995: *The latest Mideast peace agreement between Israel and the Palestinians*	11	32	29	27	1
Late September, 1993: *The peace accords between Israel and the PLO*	23	33	24	19	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Early September, 1993: *Talks between Israel and the PLO about Arab self-rule for the Gaza Strip and the West Bank town of Jericho*	19	31	23	26	1
January, 1993: *Israel's expulsion of 400 Moslem fundamentalists following the murder of an Israeli soldier in the West Bank*	10	25	31	33	1
October, 1991: *President Bush's decision to postpone loan guarantees to Israel*	15	25	30	29	1
June, 1990: *The incident in Gaza in which a deranged Israeli killed seven Palestinians and the West Bank riots that followed*	11	28	30	30	1
May, 1988: *The conflict in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis in the occupied territories*	18	37	34	9	2
c. The release of jailed American hikers held in Iran					
September 22-25, 2011	18	27	30	25	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
September 16-19, 2010: *The release of a jailed American hiker held in Iran*	16	28	27	29	1
August 7-10, 2009: *Bill Clinton securing the release of two American journalists held by North Korea*	28	35	20	15	1
April, 2001: *The release of the U.S. air crew held in China*	55	31	9	5	*
January, 1992: *The release of the last American hostages being held in Lebanon*	44	40	11	5	0
January, 1991: *The release of American hostages and other Westerners from Iraq and Kuwait*	51	37	8	3	1
d. The execution of Troy Davis, convicted of killing a police officer in Georgia					
September 22-25, 2011	20	24	22	32	2
e. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
2008 Election					
October 31-November 3, 2008: *News about the presidential election*	57	29	9	5	*
October 24-27, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	44	36	11	8	1
October 17-20, 2008	61	28	7	4	*
October 10-13, 2008	52	31	12	5	*
October 3-6, 2008	57	31	8	4	*
September 26-29, 2008	56	29	10	5	*
September 19-22, 2008	47	33	14	6	*
September 12-15, 2008	40	38	14	7	1
September 5-8, 2008	45	39	12	4	*
August 29-31, 2008	45	32	15	8	*
August 22-25, 2008	31	36	22	11	*
August 15-18, 2008	25	41	19	14	1
August 8-11, 2008	27	38	22	13	*
August 1-4, 2008	30	42	19	9	*
July 25-28, 2008	30	34	21	15	*
July 18-21, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
July 11-14, 2008	28	34	22	15	1
July 3-7, 2008	25	35	23	17	*
June 27-30, 2008	39	33	18	10	*
June 20-23, 2008	28	38	22	12	*
June 13-16, 2008	35	35	20	10	*
June 6-9, 2008	38	35	17	10	*
May 30-June 2, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
May 22-25, 2008	32	37	20	11	*
May 16-19, 2008	33	37	19	10	1
May 9-12, 2008	35	36	18	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	27	35	23	14	1
April 25-28, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
April 18-21, 2008	29	41	19	10	1
April 11-14, 2008	31	37	22	10	*
April 4-7, 2008	33	36	17	14	*
March 28-31, 2008	31	41	18	10	*
March 20-24, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
March 14-17, 2008	40	37	16	7	*
March 7-10, 2008	39	36	15	9	1
February 29-March 3, 2008	43	34	14	9	*
February 22-25, 2008	42	37	13	8	*
February 15-18, 2008	44	36	10	10	*
February 8-11, 2008	39	37	15	9	0
February 1-4, 2008	37	35	16	12	*
January 25-28, 2008	36	37	14	12	1
January 18-21, 2008	36	34	18	12	*
January 11-14, 2008: *News about the New Hampshire primaries and the presidential campaign*	32	31	19	17	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
January 4-7, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	33	36	19	11	1
December 14-17, 2007	25	34	22	19	*
December 7-10, 2007	24	35	22	19	*
November 30 – December 3, 2007	23	35	23	19	*
November 23-26, 2007	20	33	26	20	1
November 16-19, 2007	26	33	21	19	1
November 9-12, 2007	21	33	25	21	*
November 2-5, 2007	27	30	21	21	1
October 26-29, 2007	21	34	26	19	*
October 19-22, 2007	23	32	22	23	*
October 12-15, 2007	13	31	26	30	*
October 5-8, 2007	22	30	24	24	*
September 28 – October 1, 2007	21	34	25	20	*
September 21-24, 2007	24	31	22	23	*
September 14-17, 2007	22	31	24	23	*
September 7-10, 2007	18	34	26	22	*
August 30-September 2, 2007	19	35	21	25	*
August 24-27, 2007	22	28	24	26	*
August 17-20, 2007	19	27	24	30	*
August 10-13, 2007	23	32	21	24	*
August 3-6, 2007	19	31	25	25	*
July 27-30, 2007	19	32	22	26	1
July 20-23, 2007	16	26	30	27	1
July 13-16, 2007	17	29	27	27	*
July 6-9, 2007	24	29	24	22	1
June 29-July 2, 2007	20	32	25	23	*
June 22-25, 2007	18	31	21	30	*
June 15-18, 2007	17	32	26	25	*
June 8-11, 2007	19	30	24	26	1
June 1-4, 2007	16	27	32	24	1
May 24-27, 2007	22	33	23	22	*
May 18-21, 2007	18	31	24	27	*
May 11-14, 2007	18	30	23	28	1
May 4-7, 2007	23	34	21	21	1
April 27-30, 2007	14	30	29	26	1
April 20-23, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 12-16, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 5-9, 2007	25	30	26	19	*
March 30-April 2, 2007	20	29	27	23	1
March 23-26, 2007	20	32	22	26	*
March 16-19, 2007	15	28	29	27	1
March 9-12, 2007	24	30	23	23	*
March 2-5, 2007	19	31	26	23	1
February 23-26, 2007	22	33	24	21	*
February 16-19, 2007	18	32	22	27	1
February 9-12, 2007	24	30	24	21	1
February 2-5, 2007	24	36	22	18	*
January 26-29, 2007	24	33	23	20	*
January 19-22, 2007: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2008*	24	27	22	26	1
2004 Election					
November, 2004: *News about the presidential election*	47	35	10	7	1
Mid-October, 2004: *News about candidates for the 2004 presidential election*	46	30	12	11	1
September, 2004	40	34	14	11	1
August, 2004	32	38	16	14	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July, 2004	29	37	18	15	1
June, 2004	28	34	19	18	1
April, 2004	31	33	19	16	1
Mid-March, 2004	35	34	18	13	*
Late February, 2004 **(GAP)**	24	40	23	12	1
Early February, 2004: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	29	37	20	13	1
Mid-January, 2004	16	30	27	26	1
Early January, 2004	14	32	30	23	1
December, 2003	16	26	27	30	1
November, 2003	11	26	34	28	1
October, 2003	12	27	28	32	1
September, 2003	17	25	30	27	1
Mid-August, 2003	12	27	27	33	1
May, 2003	8	19	31	41	1
January, 2003: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2004*	14	28	29	28	1
2000 Election					
Early November, 2000: *News about the presidential election*	33	41	15	10	1
Mid-October, 2000: *News about the presidential election campaign*	36	35	17	11	1
Early October, 2000	35	35	19	10	1
September, 2000	22	42	21	15	1
July, 2000: *News about candidates for the 2000 presidential election*	21	38	20	20	1
June, 2000	23	32	23	21	1
May, 2000	18	33	26	23	*
April, 2000	18	39	22	20	1
March, 2000	26	41	19	13	1
February, 2000	26	36	21	17	*
January, 2000	19	34	28	18	1
December, 1999	16	36	24	23	1
October, 1999	17	32	28	22	1
September, 1999	15	31	33	20	1
July, 1999	15	38	24	22	1
June, 1999	11	25	29	34	1
1996 Election					
November, 1996: *News about the presidential election*	28	42	19	10	*
October, 1996: *News about the presidential election campaign*	31	39	18	12	*
Early September, 1996	24	36	23	17	*
July, 1996	22	40	23	14	1
April, 1996	23	35	25	17	*
March, 1996: *News about the Republican presidential candidates*	26	41	20	13	*
January, 1996	10	34	31	24	1
October, 1995	12	36	30	22	*
August, 1995	13	34	28	25	*
June, 1995	11	31	31	26	1
1992 Election					
October, 1992: *News about the presidential election (RVs)*	55	36	8	2	0
September, 1992: *News about the presidential election campaign*	42	37	13	8	*
August, 1992: *News about the presidential election* (RVs)	36	51	11	2	0

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July, 1992: *News about the presidential campaign*	20	45	26	9	*
May, 1992: *The presidential election campaign*	32	44	16	8	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	35	40	16	9	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Republican presidential nomination*	25	40	22	13	1
February 1992: *The Democratic primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	24	*
February, 1992: *The Republican primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	23	1
January, 1992: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	11	25	36	27	1
December, 1991	10	28	32	30	*
October, 1991	12	26	31	29	2
October, 1988: *News about the presidential campaign in 1988* (RVs)	43	44	11	2	*
1988 Election					
August, 1988 (RVs)	39	45	13	3	*
May, 1988 (RVs)	22	46	23	6	3
November, 1987: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	15	28	35	21	1
November, 1987: *News about the Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	13	28	36	22	1
September, 1987: *Coverage of the Democratic* and *Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	14	34	37	14	1
f. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1
December 16-19, 2010	39	31	14	15	2
December 9-12, 2010	39	30	14	16	1
December 2-5, 2010	52	28	11	9	*
November 18-21, 2010	46	31	11	11	*
November 11-14, 2010	38	30	15	16	1
November 4-7, 2010	44	32	11	13	*
October 28-November 1, 2010	39	34	11	15	1
October 21-24, 2010	41	29	14	14	1
October 14-17, 2010	42	33	12	13	*
October 7-10, 2010	36	33	15	15	1
September 30-October 3, 2010	43	35	10	11	1
September 23-26, 2010	43	34	13	9	1
September 16-19, 2010	37	30	16	16	1
September 2-6, 2010	43	31	13	12	*
August 19-22, 2010	39	31	14	15	1
August 5-8, 2010	39	33	14	13	1
July 29-August 1, 2010	51	33	11	5	*
July 22-25, 2010	46	33	14	6	1
July 15-18, 2010	37	33	14	15	1
July 8-11, 2010	36	33	15	16	*
July 1-5, 2010	48	30	13	8	*
June 24-27, 2010	37	37	15	11	1
June 17-20, 2010	38	34	15	13	*
June 10-13, 2010	39	35	17	9	*
June 3-6, 2010	35	33	16	14	1
May 27-30, 2010	43	29	13	15	*
May 20-23, 2010	40	35	13	11	*
May 13-16, 2010	49	32	11	8	1
May 7-10, 2010	42	34	11	12	*
April 30-May 3, 2010	32	37	17	14	1
April 23-26, 2010	42	31	13	14	*
April 16-19, 2010	40	32	14	14	0
April 9-12, 2010	40	32	15	13	*
April 1-5, 2010	33	34	14	19	*
March 19-22, 2010	41	32	14	13	*
March 12-15, 2010	41	35	12	12	*
March 5-8, 2010	40	34	12	13	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	31	33	17	19	*
February 19-22, 2010	38	34	15	12	*
February 12-15, 2010	35	34	15	16	*
February 5-8, 2010	43	36	13	9	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	32	13	10	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	34	14	10	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	38	14	11	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	33	15	12	*
December 18-21, 2009	45	31	14	10	0
December 11-14, 2009	42	31	14	13	*
December 4-7, 2009	41	36	13	9	1
November 13-16, 2009	38	33	14	15	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	34	32	17	16	*
October 23-26, 2009	44	30	15	10	1
October 9-12, 2009	41	29	16	13	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
October 2-5, 2009	44	30	15	11	0
September 25-28, 2009	44	37	10	10	*
September 18-21, 2009	44	34	15	7	*
September 11-14, 2009	45	32	14	9	*
September 3-6, 2009	41	31	15	13	*
August 28-31, 2009	45	30	13	12	1
August 21-24, 2009	50	27	13	10	1
August 14-17, 2009	41	37	11	12	*
August 7-10, 2009	42	34	13	10	*
July 31-August 3, 2009	46	34	11	8	*
July 24-27, 2009	45	35	12	8	*
July 17-20, 2009	43	35	11	11	1
July 10-13, 2009	37	38	13	11	*
July 2-5, 2009	38	35	15	12	*
June 19-22, 2009	42	33	15	10	*
June 12-15, 2009	41	35	12	12	*
June 5-8, 2009	41	34	11	14	*
May 29-June 1, 2009	43	37	11	8	*
May 21-24, 2009	44	35	13	9	*
May 15-18, 2009	44	35	12	8	*
May 8-11, 2009	42	34	12	12	*
May 1-4, 2009	47	36	11	5	1
April 17-20, 2009	52	30	10	7	1
April 9-13, 2009	48	29	13	10	0
March 27-30, 2009	48	32	10	10	*
March 20-23, 2009	52	34	8	6	*
March 13-16, 2009	48	33	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009	56	30	8	6	*
February 13-16, 2009	55	29	10	6	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	52	31	12	5	*
January 23-26, 2009	57	30	8	5	0
January 16-19, 2009	43	35	13	9	*
January 2-4, 2009	42	36	15	7	*
December 12-15, 2008	51	33	9	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	42	38	13	7	*
November 21-24, 2008	59	24	9	8	*
November 14-17, 2008	56	29	9	6	*
November 7-10, 2008	54	31	8	7	*
October 31-November 3, 2008	63	27	6	4	*
October 24-27, 2008	52	35	7	5	1
October 17-20, 2008	62	29	6	3	*
October 10-13, 2008	65	25	7	3	*
October 3-6, 2008	69	23	5	3	*
September 26-29, 2008	70	22	5	3	*
September 19-22, 2008	56	27	12	5	*
September 5-8, 2008	44	33	16	7	*
August 29-31, 2008	41	34	13	11	1
August 15-18, 2008	39	36	15	10	*
August 8-11, 2008	39	35	16	10	*
August 1-4, 2008	47	34	11	8	0
July 25-28, 2008	46	32	10	12	*
July 18-21, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
July 11-14, 2008	44	33	12	10	1
June 27-30, 2008	49	31	12	7	1
June 13-16, 2008	42	33	14	11	*
May 9-12, 2008	45	31	13	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	43	31	15	10	1
April 18-21, 2008	41	35	13	10	1
April 4-7, 2008	39	37	12	12	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
March 28-31, 2008	42	36	14	8	*
March 20-24, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
February 29-March 3, 2008	38	35	15	11	1
February 15-18, 2008	37	36	11	16	8
February 1-4, 2008	40	37	14	8	1
January 18-21, 2008	42	31	16	11	*
January 11-14, 2008	36	32	15	16	1
November 2-5, 2007	27	37	16	19	1
October 19-22, 2007	25	34	20	21	*
August 10-13, 2007	28	36	18	18	*
Mid-November, 2006	31	40	17	11	1
December, 2005	35	35	18	11	1
Early November, 2005	35	39	17	9	*
Mid-May, 2005	30	39	19	11	1
January, 2005	35	41	17	7	*
Mid-October, 2004	30	43	16	10	1
Early September, 2004	39	34	15	11	1
Mid-January, 2004	37	41	15	7	*
December, 2003	35	38	14	11	2
November, 2003	40	34	15	10	1
October, 2003	32	39	16	12	1
September, 2003	39	30	18	12	1
March, 2003	40	35	16	8	1
February, 2003	42	33	15	10	*
December, 2002	38	34	17	10	1
February, 2002	35	40	15	9	1
January, 2002	30	44	16	9	1
December, 2001	37	40	13	8	2
Mid-November, 2001	41	36	15	7	1
June, 2001	24	41	18	16	1
May, 2001	34	36	15	15	0
April, 2001	36	34	16	13	1
February, 2001	30	39	18	12	1
January, 2001	32	38	17	11	2
June, 1995	26	41	22	11	*
March, 1995	27	45	19	9	*
February, 1995	23	41	22	13	1
December, 1994	28	43	20	9	*
October, 1994	27	40	20	12	1
June, 1994	25	42	23	10	*
May, 1994	33	40	16	10	1
January, 1994	34	39	16	10	1
Early January, 1994	36	44	13	7	*
December, 1993	35	41	15	8	1
October, 1993	33	38	20	9	*
September, 1993	37	40	14	8	1
Early September, 1993	39	39	14	9	*
August, 1993	41	36	14	9	*
May, 1993	37	38	18	6	1
February, 1993	49	36	10	5	*
January, 1993	42	39	12	7	*
September, 1992	43	37	13	6	1
May, 1992	39	39	15	6	1
March, 1992	47	38	11	4	*
February, 1992	47	37	10	6	*
January, 1992	44	40	11	5	*
October, 1991	36	38	16	9	1

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Sep 22-25 2011	
31	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
16	The debate in Washington over jobs and the deficit
10	The execution of Troy Davis, convicted of killing a police officer in Georgia
9	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
7	The release of jailed American hikers held in Iran
5	Debate at the United Nations over the status of the Palestinian territories
6	Some other story **(VOL.)**
16	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

PEW.3 NOT RELEASED

ASK ALL:

PEW.4 How much if anything, have you heard about each of the following? Have you heard a lot, a little or nothing at all? **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**

	A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Texas Governor Rick Perry criticizing Barack Obama's policy towards Israel and the Palestinians				
September 22-25, 2011	23	42	35	1
b. Netflix announcing that it will divide into separate businesses for DVD rentals and streaming video				
September 22-25, 2011	20	32	47	1
c. A bankrupt solar panel company that had received millions in loans approved by the Obama administration				
September 22-25, 2011	29	27	43	1
d. A no longer functioning NASA satellite crashing to Earth				
September 22-25, 2011	31	40	28	1
e. The Federal Reserve moving to keep long-term interest rates low				
September 22-25, 2011	21	44	34	1

ASK ALL:

PEW.5 Now I am going to read you a series of statements that will help us understand how you feel about a number of things. For each statement, please tell me if you completely agree with it, mostly agree with it, mostly DISagree with it or completely disagree with it. The first one is... **[READ ITEMS, IN ORDER. DO NOT ROTATE.]** Do you completely agree, mostly agree, mostly DISagree, or completely disagree?

[INTERVIEWER INSTRUCTION: READ ANSWER CHOICES FOR FIRST TWO ITEMS AND THEN REPEAT AS NECESSARY]

	--------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. People like me don't have any say about what the government does							
September 22-25, 2011	52	*18*	*34*	46	*17*	*30*	1
March 31-April 21, 2009	51	*16*	*35*	46	*14*	*32*	3
January. 2007	48	*13*	*35*	50	*14*	*36*	2
August, 2003	47	*17*	*30*	51	*16*	*35*	2
August, 2002	46	*16*	*30*	51	*18*	*33*	3

PEW.5 CONTINUED…

		-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
		Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	Late September, 1999	47	*16*	*31*	52	*17*	*35*	1
	November, 1997	46	*15*	*31*	53	*18*	*35*	1
	July, 1994	54	*22*	*32*	46	*15*	*31*	*
	May, 1993	52	*15*	*37*	47	*16*	*31*	1
	June, 1992	50	*14*	*36*	49	*17*	*32*	1
	November, 1991	50	*22*	*28*	49	*21*	*28*	1
	May, 1990	57	*19*	*38*	42	*11*	*31*	1
	February, 1989	62	*22*	*40*	37	*8*	*29*	1
	May, 1988	55	*16*	*39*	44	*11*	*33*	1
	May, 1987	52	*14*	*38*	46	*12*	*34*	2
b.	Generally speaking, elected officials in Washington lose touch with the people pretty quickly							
	September 22-25, 2011	78	*39*	*39*	19	*6*	*13*	3
	March 31-April 21, 2009	76	*29*	*47*	21	*4*	*17*	3
	January, 2007	79	*31*	*48*	18	*4*	*14*	3
	August, 2003	75	*33*	*42*	22	*4*	*18*	3
	August, 2002	74	*28*	*46*	22	*4*	*18*	4
	Late September, 1999	77	*28*	*49*	21	*5*	*16*	2
	November, 1997	76	*32*	*44*	23	*5*	*18*	1
	July, 1994	83	*39*	*44*	16	*3*	*13*	1
	May, 1993	82	*29*	*53*	16	*3*	*13*	2
	June, 1992	84	*35*	*49*	15	*3*	*12*	1
	November, 1991	84	*41*	*43*	15	*4*	*11*	1
	May, 1990	78	*30*	*48*	19	*2*	*17*	3
	February, 1989	80	*30*	*50*	18	*2*	*16*	2
	May, 1988	76	*26*	*50*	22	*3*	*19*	2
	May, 1987	73	*22*	*51*	24	*3*	*21*	3
c.	Most elected officials care what people like me think							
	September 22-25, 2011	34	*7*	*27*	63	*24*	*39*	3
	March 31-April 21, 2009	38	*6*	*32*	59	*18*	*41*	3
	January, 2007	34	*3*	*31*	62	*21*	*41*	4
	August, 2003	39	*6*	*33*	59	*20*	*39*	2
	August, 2002	44	*7*	*37*	52	*17*	*35*	4
	Late September, 1999	39	*5*	*34*	59	*18*	*41*	2
	November, 1997	41	*6*	*35*	57	*19*	*38*	2
	July, 1994	33	*4*	*29*	66	*25*	*41*	1
	May, 1993	40	*5*	*35*	58	*16*	*42*	2
	June, 1992	36	*5*	*31*	62	*16*	*46*	2
	November, 1991	36	*7*	*29*	62	*23*	*39*	2
	May, 1990	44	*7*	*37*	53	*14*	*39*	3
	February, 1989	44	*5*	*39*	54	*12*	*42*	2
	May, 1988	47	*5*	*42*	51	*11*	*40*	2
	May, 1987	47	*5*	*42*	49	*9*	*40*	4
d.	Voting gives people like me some say about how government runs things							
	September 22-25, 2011	65	*25*	*40*	33	*12*	*22*	2
	March 31-April 21, 2009	68	*21*	*47*	28	*8*	*20*	4
	January, 2007	71	*23*	*48*	26	*8*	*18*	3
	August, 2003	73	*27*	*46*	24	*8*	*16*	3
	August, 2002	72	*28*	*44*	25	*9*	*16*	3
	Late September, 1999	73	*27*	*46*	24	*7*	*17*	3
	November, 1997	67	*27*	*40*	32	*9*	*23*	1
	July, 1994	66	*24*	*42*	32	*11*	*21*	2

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

	-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
November, 1991	74	*32*	*42*	24	*9*	*15*	2
May, 1990	73	*23*	*50*	25	*7*	*18*	2
February, 1989	73	*25*	*48*	25	*5*	*20*	2
May, 1988	75	*26*	*49*	23	*5*	*18*	2
May, 1987	78	*23*	*55*	19	*4*	*15*	3

NO ITEMS e-g

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

		-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			**(VOL.)**
		Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	DK/Ref
h.	The strength of this country today is mostly based on the success of American business							
	September 22-25, 2011	71	*26*	*45*	25	*8*	*17*	4
	March 31-April 21, 2009	76	*26*	*50*	20	*5*	*15*	4
	January, 2007	72	*19*	*53*	24	*6*	*18*	4
	August, 2003	75	*26*	*49*	21	*6*	*15*	4
	August, 2002	72	*22*	*50*	24	*6*	*18*	4
	February, 2002	76	*25*	*51*	20	*4*	*16*	4
	Late September, 1999	76	*23*	*53*	19	*5*	*14*	5
	November, 1997	76	*22*	*54*	21	*5*	*16*	3
	July, 1994	78	*26*	*52*	20	*5*	*15*	2
	June, 1992	78	*24*	*54*	20	*5*	*15*	2
	November, 1991	76	*29*	*47*	21	*6*	*15*	3
	May, 1990	77	*20*	*57*	17	*3*	*14*	6
	February, 1989	77	*23*	*54*	18	*4*	*14*	5
	May, 1988	79	*25*	*54*	17	*3*	*14*	4
	May, 1987	76	*16*	*60*	19	*3*	*16*	5
i.	Government regulation of business usually does more harm than good							
	September 22-25, 2011	59	*29*	*30*	36	*10*	*26*	6
	March 31-April 21, 2009	54	*23*	*31*	39	*8*	*31*	7
	January, 2007	57	*18*	*39*	35	*5*	*30*	8
	August, 2003	53	*15*	*38*	39	*9*	*30*	8
	August, 2002	48	*16*	*32*	43	*8*	*35*	9
	Late September, 1999	55	*19*	*36*	37	*6*	*31*	8
	November, 1997	57	*20*	*37*	37	*5*	*32*	6
	July, 1994	63	*27*	*36*	33	*5*	*28*	4
	June, 1992	61	*19*	*42*	33	*5*	*28*	6
	May, 1990	58	*16*	*42*	33	*4*	*29*	9
	May, 1988	57	*17*	*40*	35	*4*	*31*	8
	May, 1987	55	*12*	*43*	34	*4*	*30*	11
j.	The federal government should run ONLY those things that cannot be run at the local level							
	September 22-25, 2011	68	*30*	*38*	28	*9*	*19*	4
	March 31-April 21, 2009	70	*26*	*44*	25	*7*	*18*	5
	January, 2007	74	*27*	*47*	20	*4*	*16*	6
	August, 2003	71	*29*	*42*	24	*7*	*17*	5
	August, 2002	69	*29*	*40*	26	*6*	*20*	5
	Late September, 1999	74	*32*	*42*	22	*5*	*17*	4
	November, 1997	74	*33*	*41*	24	*7*	*17*	2
	July, 1994	78	*38*	*40*	19	*5*	*14*	3
	May, 1990	77	*26*	*51*	18	*2*	*16*	5
	May, 1987	75	*22*	*53*	19	*3*	*16*	6
k.	When something is run by the government, it is usually inefficient and wasteful							
	September 22-25, 2011	64	*29*	*35*	33	*7*	*26*	3
	March 31-April 21, 2009	57	*25*	*32*	39	*7*	*32*	4
	January, 2007	62	*24*	*38*	34	*6*	*28*	4
	August, 2003	57	*23*	*34*	39	*8*	*31*	4
	August, 2002	53	*20*	*33*	43	*8*	*35*	4
	Late September, 1999	59	*23*	*36*	38	*7*	*31*	3
	November, 1997	64	*27*	*37*	34	*7*	*27*	2
	July, 1994	69	*33*	*36*	30	*5*	*25*	1
	May, 1993	69	*24*	*45*	29	*5*	*24*	2
	June, 1992	70	*29*	*41*	28	*4*	*24*	2

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

		-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
		Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
	November, 1991	68	*32*	*36*	30	*7*	*23*	2
	May, 1990	67	*22*	*45*	29	*4*	*25*	4
	February, 1989	65	*26*	*39*	31	*5*	*26*	4
	May, 1988	66	*24*	*42*	29	*3*	*26*	5
	May, 1987	63	*19*	*44*	31	*4*	*27*	6
l.	The federal government controls too much of our daily lives							
	September 22-25, 2011	64	*36*	*28*	35	*9*	*26*	1
	March 31-April 21, 2009	55	*26*	*29*	42	*8*	*34*	3
	January, 2007	64	*28*	*36*	33	*6*	*27*	3
	August, 2003	56	*24*	*32*	42	*8*	*34*	2
	August, 2002	54	*25*	*29*	43	*8*	*35*	3
	Late September, 1999	60	*30*	*30*	38	*6*	*32*	2
	November, 1997	64	*29*	*35*	35	*6*	*29*	1
	July, 1994	69	*37*	*32*	30	*5*	*25*	1
	May, 1993	65	*26*	*39*	34	*4*	*30*	1
	June, 1992	64	*28*	*36*	34	*5*	*29*	2
	November, 1991	63	*32*	*31*	35	*7*	*28*	2
	May, 1990	62	*22*	*40*	34	*5*	*29*	4
	February, 1989	57	*22*	*35*	43	*9*	*34*	3
	May, 1988	61	*25*	*36*	36	*5*	*31*	3
	May, 1987	58	*18*	*40*	37	*5*	*32*	5
m.	The government is really run for the benefit of all the people							
	September 22-25, 2011	41	*9*	*32*	56	*22*	*34*	2
	March 31-April 21, 2009	49	*11*	*38*	48	*14*	*34*	3
	January, 2007	45	*10*	*35*	52	*15*	*37*	3
	August, 2003	52	*13*	*39*	46	*15*	*31*	2
	August, 2002	55	*13*	*42*	43	*14*	*29*	2
	Late September, 1999	49	*11*	*38*	48	*14*	*34*	3
	November, 1997	48	*9*	*39*	50	*15*	*35*	2
	July, 1994	42	*10*	*32*	57	*19*	*38*	1
	June, 1992	44	*8*	*36*	54	*17*	*37*	2
	November, 1991	48	*11*	*37*	50	*16*	*34*	2
	May, 1990	52	*10*	*42*	45	*10*	*35*	3
	February, 1989	57	*12*	*45*	41	*10*	*31*	2
	May, 1988	53	*11*	*42*	44	*10*	*34*	3
	May, 1987	57	*9*	*48*	39	*8*	*31*	4
n.	Business corporations generally strike a fair balance between making profits and serving the public interest							
	September 22-25, 2011	41	*9*	*32*	54	*21*	*33*	5
	March 31-April 21, 2009	37	*6*	*31*	58	*19*	*39*	5
	January, 2007	38	*6*	*32*	58	*19*	*39*	4
	August, 2003	38	*6*	*32*	57	*22*	*35*	5
	August, 2002	41	*7*	*34*	55	*17*	*38*	4
	February, 2002	40	*7*	*33*	54	*16*	*38*	6
	Late September, 1999	45	*7*	*38*	50	*13*	*37*	5
	November, 1997	45	*7*	*38*	52	*12*	*40*	3
	July, 1994	45	*7*	*38*	53	*15*	*38*	2
	June, 1992	40	*5*	*35*	56	*14*	*42*	4
	November, 1991	40	*8*	*32*	57	*19*	*38*	3
	May, 1990	43	*5*	*38*	50	*13*	*37*	7
	February, 1989	38	*5*	*33*	56	*12*	*44*	6
	May, 1988	42	*6*	*36*	52	*13*	*39*	6

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

	-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May, 1987	43	*4*	*39*	48	*10*	*38*	9

NO ITEM o.

p. Our society should do what is necessary to make sure that everyone has an equal opportunity to succeed

September 22-25, 2011	89	*53*	*36*	10	*4*	*6*	1
March 31-April 21, 2009	87	*48*	*39*	11	*3*	*8*	2
January, 2007	91	*49*	*42*	7	*2*	*5*	2
August, 2003	91	*53*	*38*	8	*2*	*6*	1
August, 2002	89	*52*	*37*	9	*3*	*6*	2
Late September, 1999	90	*50*	*40*	9	*2*	*7*	1
November, 1997	90	*52*	*38*	9	*3*	*6*	1
July, 1994	91	*52*	*39*	8	*2*	*6*	1
June, 1992	93	*59*	*34*	6	*2*	*4*	1
Nov, 1991	94	*64*	*30*	5	*2*	*3*	1
May, 1990	91	*45*	*46*	7	*1*	*6*	2
Feb, 1989	91	*49*	*42*	8	*2*	*6*	1
May, 1988	91	*48*	*43*	7	*1*	*6*	2
May, 1987	90	*37*	*53*	8	*1*	*7*	2

q. We have gone too far in pushing equal rights in this country

September 22-25, 2011	39	*17*	*22*	59	*31*	*28*	2
March 31-April 21, 2009	41	*16*	*25*	56	*25*	*31*	3
January, 2007	45	*17*	*28*	51	*19*	*32*	4
August, 2003	43	*17*	*26*	54	*26*	*28*	3
August, 2002	49	*20*	*29*	48	*21*	*27*	3
Late September, 1999	48	*20*	*28*	50	*21*	*29*	2
November, 1997	45	*17*	*28*	53	*21*	*32*	2
July, 1994	48	*21*	*27*	50	*22*	*28*	2
May, 1993	43	*14*	*29*	54	*20*	*34*	3
June, 1992	40	*16*	*24*	57	*27*	*30*	3
November, 1991	38	*16*	*22*	59	*27*	*32*	3
May, 1990	43	*15*	*28*	53	*21*	*32*	4
February, 1989	41	*17*	*24*	56	*22*	*34*	3
May, 1988	45	*17*	*28*	52	*20*	*32*	3
May, 1987	42	*11*	*31*	53	*16*	*37*	5

r. It is the responsibility of the government to take care of people who can't take care of themselves

September 22-25, 2011	56	*23*	*33*	41	*15*	*26*	3
March 31-April 21, 2009	63	*24*	*39*	33	*11*	*22*	4
January, 2007	69	*27*	*42*	28	*8*	*20*	3
August, 2003	66	*25*	*41*	31	*11*	*20*	3
August, 2002	61	*22*	*39*	35	*11*	*24*	4
Late September, 1999	62	*20*	*42*	35	*14*	*21*	3
November, 1997	61	*23*	*38*	37	*11*	*26*	2
July, 1994	57	*20*	*37*	41	*15*	*26*	2
May, 1993	62	*19*	*43*	35	*9*	*26*	3
June, 1992	69	*28*	*41*	28	*8*	*20*	3
May, 1990	67	*23*	*44*	29	*6*	*23*	4
May, 1988	74	*26*	*48*	23	*6*	*17*	3
May, 1987	71	*21*	*50*	24	*4*	*20*	5

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

		-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
		Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
s.	The government should help more needy people even if it means going deeper in debt							
	September 22-25, 2011	42	*16*	*27*	54	*25*	*29*	4
	March 31-April 21, 2009	48	*16*	*32*	46	*14*	*32*	6
	January, 2007	54	*19*	*35*	40	*11*	*29*	6
	August, 2003	54	*17*	*37*	42	*12*	*30*	4
	August, 2002	48	*16*	*32*	47	*15*	*32*	5
	Late September, 1999	49	*15*	*34*	47	*14*	*33*	4
	November, 1997	44	*14*	*30*	53	*16*	*37*	3
	July, 1994	41	*13*	*28*	56	*19*	*37*	3
	May, 1993	43	*9*	*34*	52	*12*	*40*	5
	June, 1992	53	*18*	*35*	43	*12*	*31*	4
	November, 1991	51	*20*	*31*	46	*15*	*31*	3
	May, 1990	51	*15*	*36*	44	*10*	*34*	5
	May, 1988	52	*17*	*35*	42	*12*	*30*	6
	May, 1987	53	*13*	*40*	40	*7*	*33*	7
t.	The government should guarantee every citizen enough to eat and a place to sleep							
	September 22-25, 2011	56	*26*	*29*	42	*18*	*24*	2
	March 31-April 21, 2009	62	*28*	*34*	35	*12*	*23*	3
	January, 2007	69	*31*	*38*	29	*8*	*21*	2
	August, 2003	65	*30*	*35*	33	*10*	*23*	2
	August, 2002	63	*28*	*35*	34	*11*	*23*	3
	Late September, 1999	64	*29*	*35*	33	*11*	*22*	3
	November, 1997	62	*29*	*33*	36	*11*	*25*	2
	July, 1994	59	*27*	*32*	39	*14*	*25*	2
	June, 1992	65	*32*	*33*	32	*10*	*22*	3
	November, 1991	73	*41*	*32*	25	*9*	*16*	2
	May, 1990	62	*27*	*35*	34	*9*	*25*	4
	February, 1989	65	*35*	*30*	32	*10*	*22*	3
	May, 1988	66	*28*	*38*	31	*9*	*22*	3
	May, 1987	62	*22*	*40*	33	*7*	*26*	5
u.	I like political leaders who are willing to make compromises in order to get the job done							
	September 22-25, 2011	76	*36*	*40*	22	*8*	*14*	2
	March 31-April 21, 2009	79	*37*	*42*	17	*5*	*12*	4
	January, 2007	79	*29*	*50*	16	*5*	*11*	5
	August, 2003	77	*28*	*49*	19	*6*	*13*	4
	August, 2002	78	*30*	*48*	18	*6*	*12*	4
	Late September, 1999	77	*32*	*45*	19	*4*	*15*	4
	November, 1997	78	*32*	*46*	19	*5*	*14*	3
	May, 1990	71	*23*	*48*	23	*6*	*17*	6
	May, 1988	72	*23*	*49*	22	*5*	*17*	6
	May, 1987	72	*16*	*56*	20	*4*	*16*	8
v.	I am very patriotic							
	September 22-25, 2011	85	*54*	*31*	13	*4*	*9*	2
	March 31-April 21, 2009	88	*54*	*34*	9	*3*	*6*	3
	January, 2007	90	*49*	*41*	8	*2*	*6*	2
	August, 2003	91	*56*	*35*	7	*2*	*5*	2
	August, 2002	92	*54*	*38*	6	*2*	*4*	2
	Late September, 1999	87	*49*	*38*	11	*3*	*8*	2
	November, 1997	90	*48*	*42*	8	*2*	*6*	2
	July, 1994	91	*51*	*40*	8	*2*	*6*	1
	June, 1992	91	*52*	*39*	7	*2*	*5*	2
	November, 1991	91	*58*	*33*	7	*2*	*5*	2

PEW.5 CONTINUED…

	-------AGREE------			-----DISAGREE----			
	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	Net	Com-pletely	Mostly	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May, 1990	88	*48*	*40*	10	*2*	*8*	2
February, 1989	91	*51*	*40*	7	*1*	*6*	2
May, 1988	89	*51*	*38*	8	*2*	*6*	3
May, 1987	89	*43*	*46*	8	*1*	*7*	3

And a different kind of question…

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.1 Some people think of American society as divided into two groups, the "haves" and the "have-nots," while others think it's incorrect to think of America that way. Do you, yourself, think of America as divided into haves and have-nots, or don't you think of America that way?

	Yes, divided	No	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 22-25, 2011	45	52	2
April 21-26, 2010	42	53	5
April 14-21, 2009	35	62	3
Early October, 2008	44	53	3
January, 2008	43	54	3
July, 2007	48	48	4
September, 2006	41	55	4
Early October, 2005	48	50	2
Late March, 2005	38	59	3
Late February, 2004	38	59	3
June, 2001	44	53	3
April, 1998 *Gallup*	39	59	2
July, 1988 *Gallup*	26	71	3
Aug, 1984 *CBS/NY Times*	31	61	8

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.2 If you had to choose, which of these groups are you in, the haves or the have-nots?

	Haves	Have-nots	**(VOL.)** Neither	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 22-25, 2011	48	34	11	7
April 21-26, 2010	45	36	9	10
April 14-21, 2009	48	36	7	9
Early October, 2008	47	38	8	7
January, 2008	50	34	10	6
July, 2007	45	34	13	8
September, 2006	52	29	10	9
Early October, 2005	47	38	11	4
Late March, 2005	48	34	8	10
Late February, 2004	59	27	7	7
June, 2001	52	32	10	6
April, 1998 *Gallup*	67	24	6	3
July, 1988 *Gallup*	59	17	15	9

ASK ALL:
RANDOMIZE PEWWP.3 AND PEWWP.4

PEWWP.3 On the whole, do you think the Obama administration is doing more to help the haves, doing more to help the have-nots, or it is treating both groups about the same?

		Global Attitudes			*Gallup*
		Obama	**GW Bush**	**GW Bush**	**Reagan**
Sep 22-25 2011		Apr 14-21 2009	Feb 2004	June 2001	Aug 1988[1]
15	Helping the haves	8	47	43	49
29	Helping the have-nots	30	4	4	4
45	Treating about the same	51	42	40	39
4	Neither **(VOL.)**	2	1	2	2
7	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	9	6	11	6

ASK ALL:
RANDOMIZE PEWWP.3 AND PEWWP.4

PEWWP.4 On the whole, do you think the Republicans in Congress are doing more to help the haves, doing more to help the have-nots, or it is treating both groups about the same?

Sep 22-25 2011	
47	Helping the haves
7	Helping the have-nots
32	Treating about the same
4	Neither **(VOL.)**
9	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

Next…

PEW.6 As you may know, political leaders are debating various ways to reduce the deficit and size of the national debt. Please tell me if you would approve or disapprove of each of the following. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE; OBSERVE FORM SPLITS]** Would you strongly approve, approve, disapprove or strongly disapprove of this as a way to reduce the size of the national debt? What about **[NEXT ITEM]**? **[IF NECESSARY:** Would you strongly approve, approve, disapprove or strongly disapprove of this as a way to reduce the size of the national debt?**]**[2]

		-----APPROVE-----			------DISAPPROVE-------			
			Strongly			Strongly		**(VOL.)**
		Net	App-rove	App-rove	Net	Dis-approve	Dis-approve	DK/Ref
a.	Reduce federal funding for programs that help lower-income Americans							
	September 22-25, 2011	41	*12*	*28*	55	*20*	*35*	4
	May 25-30, 2011	40	--	--	54	--	--	6
b.	Reduce military commitments overseas							
	September 22-25, 2011	66	*26*	*40*	30	*9*	*20*	4
	May 25-30, 2011	65	--	--	30	--	--	6

[1] Question was worded: "On the whole, do you think the Reagan Administration has done more to help the haves or the have-nots, or do you think it has treated both groups about the same?"

[2] In December 2010, question began, "Thinking about ways to reduce the federal budget deficit…" and in May 2011, the question began, "Thinking about ways to reduce the deficit and size of the national debt…" In December, 2010 and May, 2011 respondents were not asked whether they strongly approve/disapprove.

PEW.6 CONTINUED…

		-----APPROVE-----			------DISAPPROVE-------			
			Strongly			Strongly		**(VOL.)**
		Net	App-rove	App-rove	Net	Dis-approve	Dis-approve	DK/Ref
c.	Reduce federal funding to states for things like education and roads							
	September 22-25, 2011	32	*10*	*22*	66	*30*	*36*	2
	May 25-30, 2011	23	--	--	73	--	--	4
	Dec 1-5, 2010	25	--	--	71	--	--	4
d.	Limit tax deductions for large corporations							
	September 22-25, 2011	56	*25*	*31*	39	*14*	*26*	5
	May 25-30, 2011	62	--	--	34	--	--	4
e.	Raise the income tax rate on incomes over $250,000 a year							
	September 22-25, 2011	67	*33*	*34*	29	*10*	*20*	4
	May 25-30, 2011	66	--	--	31	--	--	3
f.	Making changes to the Social Security and Medicare programs							
	September 22-25, 2011	49	*16*	*32*	45	*19*	*27*	6

ASK ALL:

PEW.7 How much confidence do you have in **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** to do the right thing when it comes to dealing with the federal budget deficit – a great deal of confidence, a fair amount of confidence, not too much confidence, or no confidence at all? What about **[NEXT ITEM]**?

		A great deal	A fair amount	Not too much	No confidence at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	Barack Obama					
	September 22-25, 2011	18	34	21	25	2
	May 25-30, 2011	22	33	22	21	2
	Dec 1-5, 2010	19	34	20	24	4
b.	Republican leaders in Congress					
	September 22-25, 2011	5	30	31	31	4
	May 25-30, 2011	7	40	31	20	2
	Dec 1-5, 2010	6	34	29	27	4
c.	Democratic leaders in Congress					
	September 22-25, 2011	10	33	29	24	3
	May 25-30, 2011	12	39	28	18	3
	Dec 1-5, 2010	9	33	28	24	5

ASK ALL:

PARTY In politics TODAY, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat, or independent?

ASK IF INDEP/NO PREF/OTHER/DK/REF (PARTY=3,4,5,9):

PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or more to the Democratic Party?

	Republican	Democrat	Independent	**(VOL.)** No preference	**(VOL.)** Other party	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
September 22-25, 2011	23	30	39	4	*	3	*14*	*16*

ASK ALL:

TEAPARTY2 From what you know, do you agree or disagree with the Tea Party movement, or don't you have an opinion either way?

	Agree	Disagree	No opinion either way	(VOL.) Haven't heard of	(VOL.) Refused	*Not heard of/ DK*
September 22-25, 2011	19	29	46	2	3	--
Aug 17-21, 2011	20	27	50	1	1	--
Jul 20-24, 2011	20	24	53	1	1	--
Jun 15-19, 2011	20	26	50	3	2	--
May 25-30, 2011	18	23	54	2	2	--
Mar 30-Apr 3, 2011	22	29	47	1	1	--
Mar 8-14, 2011	19	25	54	1	1	--
Feb 22-Mar 1, 2011	20	25	52	2	2	--
Feb 2-7, 2011[3]	22	22	53	2	2	--
Jan 5-9, 2011	24	22	50	2	1	--
Dec 1-5, 2010	22	26	49	2	2	--
Nov 4-7, 2010	27	22	49	1	1	--
Oct 27-30, 2010 *(RVs)*	29	25	32	--	1	*13*
Oct 13-18, 2010 *(RVs)*	28	24	30	--	1	*16*
Aug 25-Sep 6, 2010 *(RVs)*	29	26	32	--	1	*13*
Jul 21-Aug 5, 2010	22	18	37	--	1	*21*
Jun 16-20, 2010	24	18	30	--	*	*27*
May 20-23, 2010	25	18	31	--	1	*25*
Mar 11-21, 2010	24	14	29	--	1	*31*

3 In the February 2-7, 2011 survey and before, question read "…do you strongly agree, agree, disagree or strongly disagree with the Tea Party movement…"In October 2010 and earlier, question was asked only of those who had heard or read a lot or a little about the Tea Party. In May through October, it was described as: "the Tea Party movement that has been involved in campaigns and protests in the U.S. over the past year." In March it was described as "the Tea Party protests that have taken place in the U.S. over the past year."